

AaaS Update Guide

How to apply the 2026-04-24 patch to your existing AaaS Portable install

WHY THIS GUIDE You already have a working AaaS Portable install. This update is a tiny patch (~260 KB) that refreshes the widget and adds a new auto-heal system for AI models. No re-install needed — just 5 quick steps below.

What's new in this update

- **Odia streaming** — long paragraphs start speaking in ~1 second instead of ~5.
- **Mic → English** — speak Odia or Hindi; the form field gets English. Digits convert automatically (■■■■■ → 2025).
- **Translation safety net** — if translate can't produce real English, the form stays empty with a red error (no more silent Odia-in-English-form).
- **Smart hover-to-speak** — speaks the button's *visible* text, not its hidden accessibility annotation. Icon buttons still fall back to the annotation correctly.
- **Auto-heal models** — NEW. A one-click script checks every AI model and downloads anything missing. If a gated model is unavailable, it configures a clean fallback.
- **DevTools diagnostics** — hover logs [AaaS/hover] every element so any remaining issues are easy to report.

Update in 6 steps

1

Close the running demo

If you have the four AaaS service terminal windows open, close each of them by clicking the **X**. Leaving them open is fine too — widget files are only read when pages load.

2

Unzip this update

Extract the update zip into the **same parent folder** that contains your existing AaaS-Portable\ folder.

Example: if your install is at C:\AaaS\AaaS-Portable\, extract into C:\AaaS\. When Windows asks, click **Yes to All** to overwrite existing files.

3

Run the auto-heal (NEW)

Double-click **ENSURE-READY.bat** inside your AaaS-Portable\ folder.

It verifies every AI model is present and healthy. If anything's missing, it downloads it automatically. Fast (~5 seconds) when everything's intact; up to a few minutes on first run if models need fetching.

Expected output for a healthy install:

```
[OK] MMS-TTS Odia
[OK] MMS-TTS Hindi
[OK] MMS-TTS English
[OK] NLLB-200 distilled-600M
[OK] IndicWav2Vec Odia
READY – safe to run RUN-DEMO.bat.
```

4

Reload the browser extension

Chrome caches content scripts, so a refresh alone isn't enough.

- Open `chrome://extensions` in Chrome or Edge.
- Find **AaaS Accessibility Companion (Odisha)**.
- Click the circular **Reload** icon on the extension's tile.

5

Refresh demo tabs

Press **F5** (or **Ctrl+R**) on any open AaaS demo page. The updated `widget.js` only takes effect after a full reload.

6

Start the demo

Double-click **RUN-DEMO.bat**. Four terminal windows open, one per service. After ~15 seconds the demo landing page opens in your browser at `http://127.0.0.1:8000/demo/`.

Verify the update worked

Three quick smoke tests — should take under a minute total.

Test 1 — Odia streaming (1 minute)

Open a demo page. In the widget panel (bottom-right blue button), set language to **Odia**. Click **Read this page**. You should hear the first sentence within about one second. Before this update, long paragraphs waited ~5 seconds before anything played.

Test 2 — Mic fills English (30 seconds)

Open the Utkal University demo. Click into the **Name** text field. Click the mic button in the widget. Say *my name is Priya* in Odia (e.g., ■■■■ ■■■■ ■■■■■■■■). Click the mic again to stop.

Expected: the widget's transcript strip shows your Odia speech. The form field receives the English translation. The status line reads `Filled field (or → en)`.

Test 3 — Smart hover (30 seconds)

In the widget panel, toggle **Hover to speak** on. Hover any button or link on the demo page. The widget should speak exactly the visible text you're pointing at — not an aria-label or hidden annotation.

If something goes wrong

"ENSURE-READY.bat: .venv-portable not found"

You've never run the full SETUP-FRIEND.bat. Do that first (5–10 minutes on a fresh laptop), then come back to step 3 above.

Auto-heal fails to download a model

- Check your internet connection and re-run **ENSURE-READY.bat**.
- For the gated AI4Bharat Odia STT model, see the next section.
- If you're on a corporate firewall, try a personal hotspot.

Widget still behaves like the old version

Chrome aggressively caches content scripts. If step 4 didn't work, try:

- Close the demo tab completely (right-click → Close tab), then reopen.
- In `chrome://extensions`, toggle the AaaS Companion off and on.
- As a last resort: remove the extension, then re-add it via **Load unpacked** pointing at `AaaS-Portable\apps\extension\`.

Mic records but no audio plays after

Chrome blocks audio until you interact with the page. Click anywhere on the page first, then try the mic.

Status shows "Transcribed (or) — translation unavailable"

This is expected if the translate service is offline or hit a phrase it can't translate cleanly. The form is deliberately left empty instead of filled with Odia. Close the Translate terminal window, re-run `RUN-DEMO.bat`.

Optional: enable real Odia speech recognition

Without this setup, the mic uses a mock engine that returns canned phrases regardless of what you say. To get real Odia transcription:

A

Create a HuggingFace account

Go to <https://huggingface.co> and sign up. Free.

B

Request model access

Visit huggingface.co/ai4bharat/indicwav2vec-odia. Click **Agree and access repository**. Access is auto-approved immediately.

C

Create a token

At huggingface.co/settings/tokens, click **Create new token**. Name it anything, type **Read**. Copy the `hf_...` string — you only see the full value once.

D

Set the token + re-run auto-heal

Open a Command Prompt, paste:

```
set HF_TOKEN=hf_your_token_here
ENSURE-READY.bat
```

The script downloads the Odia STT model (~870 MB) and flips the STT service from mock to real. Run `RUN-DEMO.bat` and the mic now transcribes what you actually said.

NEED MORE HELP See `README-FOR-FRIEND.md` in the `AaaS-Portable` folder for full install and usage docs. Browser DevTools (F12 → Console tab) show diagnostic lines starting with `[AaaS/hover]` that make debugging easy to report back.